

Tools for cue programming in REAPER

Built for lighting designers who write their timecode cues as markers. Each guide is one page — what the plugin is for, how to use it, and the things that are easy to trip over.

THE PLUGINS

steelblue LD Tools

All of it in one window in REAPER's bottom docker: the live tempo in the header, and Rename, MIDI and Copy as tabs. Opens with REAPER.

[Start here](#)

Live BPM Analyzer

Reads the real tempo out of the audio, to two decimals, and sets the project tempo without moving anything you have already placed.

MIDI notes to project markers

Write your cue rhythm as MIDI and get a marker on every note — named after the note, coloured by pitch.

Rename selected markers

Builds MA-Tools cue names for a whole set of markers at once, with a live preview and cue numbering that wraps.

Copy Markers

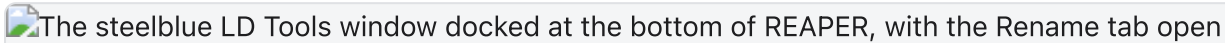
Copies a block of markers somewhere else, keeping spacing, names and colours.

THE WORKSPACE

Since version 2.0 the package holds one more thing, and it is the one most people end up using: **steelblue LD Tools**, a single window that sits in REAPER's bottom docker next to the

Mixer.

It is the same four tools, together. The live tempo read-out lives in its header band and keeps measuring whatever else you are doing; below it are three tabs — **Rename selected markers**, **MIDI notes to markers**, **Copy Markers** — and one status line that belongs to whichever tab is open. What the Region/Marker Manager has selected is read once and shown at the top, so all three tabs see the same thing.



The steelblue LD Tools window docked at the bottom of REAPER, with the Rename tab open

The workspace in the bottom docker, Rename tab open.

It opens with REAPER. The installer writes a small marked block into `__startup.eel` in REAPER's Scripts folder, so the window is there on every start — no shortcut to press, nothing to remember. If you would rather not have that, delete the block between the two `// steelblue LD Tools: autostart` comment lines.

To open or close it by hand, run `steelblue_workspace.lua` from the Action List, or use the shortcut you assigned during install. It is a switch: running it while the window is open closes it.

The four single plugins are still installed and still work exactly as they always have — [the workspace guide](#) has the details.

INSTALLING

One script does the whole job. It takes about a minute.

1 Open the package and start the installer

In REAPER: `Actions` → `Show Action List` → `New action...` → `Load ReaScript...`, then pick `steelblue_install.lua` from the package and run it.

That is the only fiddly bit, and it only happens once.

2 Let it install the two extensions

REAPER needs **RealmGui** for the plugin windows, and **js_ReaScriptAPI** for the cue numbering in *Rename selected markers*. Neither ships with REAPER — so both are in the package, and the installer puts the right build for your machine in place. Nothing to download.

Already have one of them? It is left strictly alone. The installer never overwrites or downgrades what you have; if ReaPack manages your extensions, ReaPack stays in charge.

3 Give each plugin a shortcut

The installer registers **five actions** — the four plugins and `steelblue_workspace.lua`, which is the LD Tools window — and opens REAPER's shortcut dialog once for each. Press whatever keys suit you; a script is not allowed to set a key binding, it can only open that dialog, so the choice is genuinely yours.

Skipping is fine. Everything also runs from `Actions` → `Show Action List` under the plugin's file name, and you can add shortcuts there whenever you like. The workspace opens on its own anyway.

4 Quit REAPER, then open it again

The installer offers to quit for you. REAPER only loads extensions when it starts, so the plugins come alive the moment you reopen it — not before.

After that the package has done its work: the plugins live in REAPER's own Scripts folder now, so you can throw it away.

The one thing everybody trips over: before starting a marker plugin from a shortcut, click once into the arrange view. While the Region/Marker Manager has keyboard focus it swallows the shortcut — the window never appears, and your selection is cleared for good measure.

TRY IT OUT

The `Demo Project` folder in the package contains a small REAPER project — a beat at exactly 128 BPM, a MIDI item, and five named markers — so you can follow every step in these guides without touching a real show file.